non-violent philosophy and worked with him on social welfare programmes.

A woman in power

Kaur was the only woman in the first cabinet of independent India and served as India's health minister for ten years. During this time, she helped set up several medical colleges and institutions, improved sanitary conditions across the country, oversaw programmes on maternal health and child welfare and worked towards reducing the spread of diseases like malaria and tuberculosis. Kaur was instrumental in founding the prestigious All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), which continues to be one of India's premier medical institutions. She also worked closely with humanitarian organizations like the Indian Red Cross and St John's Ambulance Brigade. She received many honours for her dedication to improving public health.



The government of India released a commemorative stamp on Kaur's birth centenary to honour India's first health minister.